

Module 14: Solutions, Governance, and the Future

Service Learning Project

From Classroom to Council: Presenting Migration Solutions to Real Stakeholders

Overview

The capstone service project: refine a policy, program, or intervention proposal from the course and present it to actual stakeholders — a community coalition, campus leadership, or local government forum.

Aligned learning outcomes

- Summarize key solutions for a public audience (UG 1)
- Identify stakeholders and their interests (UG 2)
- Explain governance approaches at the right level (UG 3)
- Propose interventions and defend them (UG 4)

Suggested community partners

- NGO coalitions and refugee advocacy networks
- City council members or offices of new Americans (public comment, briefings)
- Campus administration (for campus-level proposals, e.g., Every Campus a Refuge)
- Community foundations hosting civic forums

Project steps

1. Select and refine one proposal developed during the course (any module's project can seed it).
2. Map the stakeholders: who decides, who benefits, who bears costs, who must be consulted.
3. Consult at least one community organization affected by the proposal and revise based on their input.
4. Prepare the stakeholder briefing: two-page brief plus short presentation, in the register the venue expects.
5. Deliver the presentation at a real venue (partner meeting, public comment, campus forum, organized course summit with invited stakeholders).
6. Debrief: what feedback did you get, and what would version two look like?

Deliverables

- Two-page stakeholder brief
- Delivered presentation (slides or script)
- Stakeholder feedback debrief (2 pages)

Time commitment

15 hours plus the presentation event.

Ethics requirements

Proposals affecting a community are shared with that community first; feedback is credited.

Grading rubric

Each criterion is scored at one of four levels, then weighted as shown. The overall grade is the weighted combination of criterion scores. Instructors may adapt weights and descriptors to local requirements.

Criterion (weight)	Exemplary (A)	Proficient (B)	Developing (C)	Beginning (D–F)
Quality and realism of the proposal 30%	Design judgment is excellent: quality and realism of the proposal is fully addressed — costs, constraints, politics, and failure modes are named honestly and the proposal remains workable anyway.	Design judgment is good: quality and realism of the proposal is addressed for the major factors, with minor blind spots that would not sink the proposal.	Design judgment is limited: quality and realism of the proposal is addressed superficially — key constraints or failure modes are ignored, making the proposal fragile.	Design judgment is missing: quality and realism of the proposal is not addressed; the proposal ignores obvious constraints and would not survive contact with reality.
Evidence of genuine community consultation 25%	Collaboration is genuinely shared: evidence of genuine community consultation is fully realized — partner and community voices shaped key decisions, their priorities are visible in the result, and their contribution is credited.	Collaboration is real: evidence of genuine community consultation is achieved — the partner reviewed and influenced the work, though some decisions stayed one-sided.	Collaboration is thin: evidence of genuine community consultation is claimed more than practiced; the partner was consulted late or superficially, and the result reflects the student's assumptions.	Collaboration is absent: evidence of genuine community consultation did not occur; the work was done about or for the community rather than with it.
Effectiveness of the stakeholder presentation 30%	Performance under questioning is outstanding: effectiveness of the stakeholder presentation shows command of the material, direct engagement with hard questions, and revision that visibly improved the work.	Performance is solid: effectiveness of the stakeholder presentation shows good command and reasonable answers to challenges, with revision addressing the main feedback.	Performance is shaky: effectiveness of the stakeholder presentation shows incomplete command — questions deflected or answered vaguely, revision cosmetic.	Performance is inadequate: effectiveness of the stakeholder presentation shows the student could not explain or defend their own work, and feedback was not incorporated.
Debrief honesty and insight 15%	Reflection is genuinely self-examining: debrief honesty and insight shows specific assumptions confronted with evidence, real change or evidenced confirmation, and questions that extend beyond the assignment.	Reflection is substantive: debrief honesty and insight shows honest engagement with the student's own thinking, supported by course material, with occasional generality.	Reflection is surface-level: debrief honesty and insight is attempted but stays safe or generic — conclusions asserted rather than examined, little connection to evidence.	Reflection is performative or missing: debrief honesty and insight shows no genuine self-examination or contradicts the evidence presented.